

Creamy Pumpkin Baked Rigatoni

with Mozzarella, Fontina, and Fried Sage

Tonight's repeat favorite pasta bake features three cheeses, golden breadcrumbs, nutmeg, and seasonal pumpkin. It's ideal for impressing guests at home, or assembling in advance of a holiday potluck or group supper (check out our make-ahead tips in Steps 1 and 2). We also fry sage leaves for an elegant garnish, then use the fragrant oil to sauté aromatics for the sauce.

35–45 minutes 990 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- ¼ ounce sage
- 2 red onions
- 4 cloves garlic
- 1 ounce grated Parmesan cheese
- ½ cup panko breadcrumbs
- 5 packets unsalted butter
- 1 spice mix
  - ¼ teaspoon ground cayenne pepper
  - ¼ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- 2 tablespoons flour
- 1 pound rigatoni
- 3 containers milk
- 1 cup pumpkin purée
- 4 ounces shredded Fontina cheese
- 6 ounces shredded mozzarella cheese
- 2 aluminum tins

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
10" large pot
12" large high-sided pan
baking sheet

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Prepping ahead? Complete Steps 1-6, but wait to preheat oven and top pasta with breadcrumbs (keep separate until ready to serve). Cover pasta in tin with plastic wrap and refrigerate up to 1 day ahead. Let come to room temperature, then add breadcrumbs and bake.

If prepping in advance, fry and drain sage, then store in an airtight container at room temperature until ready to serve.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F (see recipe tip). Bring a large pot of water to a boil over high heat. Pick **sage** leaves, discarding stems. Peel **onions**, halve, and thinly slice. Mince **garlic**. Add **Parmesan** to bag with **breadcrumbs** and shake to combine, then set aside until Step 6.



2. Fry sage leaves

Heat **2 tablespoons olive oil** in a large high-sided pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **1 sage leaf** to pan. If it sizzles immediately, keep going; if not, try again once the oil is hotter. Fry **remaining sage** until slightly crisp, 1–2 minutes. Remove pan from heat. Using a slotted spoon, transfer **sage** to a paper towel–lined plate to drain, leaving **sage oil** behind in pan for the next step (see recipe tip).



3. Sauté aromatics

Return pan with **sage oil** to medium-high heat and add **butter**. When butter is foamy, add **onions**; sauté, stirring frequently, until light brown and softened, 5–7 minutes (move on to Step 4, but don't forget to come back!). Then, add **spice mix**, **garlic**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired; cook, stirring, until fragrant, 1–2 minutes. Reduce heat under pan to medium, add **flour**, and stir to combine.



4. Cook rigatoni

While aromatics cook, season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **rigatoni** and cook until almost al dente, about 8 minutes (it will finish cooking in the oven). Use the downtime while the pasta cooks to set the table or relax with a glass of wine. Reserve **½ cup pasta cooking water**, then drain and set aside.



5. Make creamy pumpkin sauce

To pan with aromatics, add **milk**. Bring to a boil over high heat, then reduce heat to medium and add **pumpkin purée**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper**. Cook, stirring, until thickened, 2–3 minutes. Remove pan from heat and stir in **Fontina** and **mozzarella**. Add cooked **rigatoni** and toss to coat. Adding 1 tablespoon at a time, stir in **reserved pasta cooking water** until sauce is silky and clings to noodles.



6. Bake and plate rigatoni

Place **tins** on a baking sheet, reshaping if bent. Taste **creamy pumpkin rigatoni** and add **salt** and **black pepper** as desired. Divide between **tins** and spread in an even layer. Sprinkle over **Parmesan breadcrumbs** and drizzle with **olive oil**. Bake until breadcrumbs are golden, 5–7 minutes. Divide among serving plates, garnish with **fried sage**, and dig in!

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